have been designed for a time when access to education was more limited, may not serve the purpose in the new circumstances prevailing today. The default pedagogy of 'completing the textbook', does not reflect the learning levels of children in the classroom, as they always remain behind the textbook expects them to be. Evidences suggest that the 'business-as-usual' pedagogy – simply following the textbooks – can be improved with large positive impacts in early grades that target the child's current level of learning:

i. These positive results have been found consistently in programmes run by non-profit organisations in several locations (including UP, Bihar, Uttaranchal, Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Andhra Pradesh).

ii. The estimated impact of these interventions have been considerably high often exceeding the learning gains from a full year of schooling (their instructional time period is typically only a small fraction of the duration of the scheduled school year).

iii. These interventions are typically delivered by modestly paid community teachers, who mostly do not have formal teacher training.

iv. The supplemental remedial instruction programmes are highly cost effective and deliver significant learning gains at much lower costs than the large investments in standard schooling system.

Governance

Another explanation for the 'low correlation between increases in spending on educational inputs and improved learning outcomes' may be the *weak governance* of the education system and limited effort on the part of teachers and administrators to improve student learning levels:

i. The most striking symptom of weak governance is the high rate of teacher absence in government-run schools. While teacher absence rates were over 25 per cent across India in 2003, an all-India panel survey in 2010 that covered the same villages found that teacher absence in rural India was still around 24 per cent.

ii. The fiscal cost of teacher absence was estimated at around Rs 7,500 crore per year suggesting that governance challenges remain